



NIGHTMARE VIBE

Carlos Prates, aka The Nightmare, made his UFC debut last February and has **not looked back since.**

Nigamanth P

nigamanth.p@thehindu.co.in

It takes courage and determination to make it into the Ultimate Fighting Championship, but it takes much more to sustain and succeed.

Numerous fighters make their UFC debuts every year, but only a few stand out from the rest. Brazil's Carlos Prates is one such fighter who made a name for himself in his first couple of fights.

On the surface, one might assume Prates' inclusion in the UFC roster was due to his impressive performance at Dana White's Contender Series, where he scored a second-round knockout against Mitch Ramirez. But it's much more than that.

Prates made his professional MMA debut in 2012 and had over 20 fights

under his belt before he decided to try his hand at the UFC. He went on to clinch the welterweight title at the Sao Paulo-based MMA promotion Standout Fighting Tournament in 2022.

Cut to February 2024: 'The Nightmare' made his UFC debut and did not look back. He adjusted seamlessly, earning a Performance of the Night bonus for his knockout of Trevin Giles.

He pocketed another bonus four months later, knocking out Charles Radtke in the first round. But he was just getting started. He closed out 2024 with back-to-back knockouts of

